



### Salar Jung Collection

The collection at the Salar Jung museum in Hyderabad can be explored on Google Maps. <https://digit.in/Aug18-95-1>



### The history of steel

Tracing the path of steel used in our blades, all the way back to the furnaces in the hearts of dead stars. <https://digit.in/Aug18-95-2>



#### BAGH NAKH

The bagh nakh or wagh nakh can be translated into English as the tiger's claws. The weapon was used by Rajput assassins as it could easily be easily concealed within the palm of the hand. A gory and fatal form of martial arts called naki ka kusti involved intoxicated wrestlers disemboweling each other.



#### BICHUA

The dagger is shaped like the horn of a buffalo or the sting of a scorpion. It typically had a decorative knuckle guard. Early forms of the weapon came from the Vijayanagara kingdom. A melee weapon called the bichua bagh nakh combined the dagger and the tiger's claws into a single instrument of death.



#### ANKUSH

The Ankush or the elephant goad is was a weapon used to control elephants. There was a spear tip and a hook to the weapon. Both the tips were used to apply pressure to various sensitive points all over the body of the elephant, directing its movements. The purpose of the hook is to reach the hard to reach areas of the elephant. The ankush was used to control war elephants. The ankush could be made of a wide range of materials, including wood, metal and even ivory.



#### MADUVU

The maduvu, madu or singhauta is made from two horns of a blackbuck facing opposite directions. The horns can also be used singly, or attached to either side of a shield. At times, the horns of an antelope could be used. In Punjab, a variant of the weapon was made entirely out of metal.



#### VAJRAMUSHTI

Vajramushti is a weapon similar to brass knuckles, and is also the name of the martial arts where the use of the weapon is taught. The weapon is typically made out of ivory or buffalo horn. In combat, the weapon had blades on both sides, as well as a third blade on top of the brass knuckle itself.



#### BHUJ

The Bhuj is a weapon originating from the city of the same name. Essentially it is a handle with a knife on top, with the blade mounted in a manner that is similar to an axe. The handle typically had an elephant ornament just below the blade, which is why the weapon is also known as the elephant knife.



#### GUPTI

The Gupti is also known as a sword stick, and is a short sword hidden within a stick. The sword was common in northern and central India, and could be used to carry the weapon in a concealed form. The blade was often screwed into the scabbard, which meant drawing it out was a slow process.

#### VALARI

A valari or the vali tadi is a throwing stick that was used by the Tamil people to protect cattle from predators and to hunt deer. A blow aimed to the neck could kill a beast, while a throw aimed the ankles or legs would allow the animal to be caught alive. The throwing stick was made in various shapes and sizes.



#### RAMDAO

The Ramdao was a sacrificial sword used in East India, mostly in West Bengal and Orissa. The heavy chopper had a thick spine. It could cut off the head of a goat, or even a bull with a single stroke. The spines of the blades were inlaid with motifs. The sword was used for animal sacrifice, and not for actual fighting.



#### KIRPAN

The Kirpan is a small dagger, that is worn by Sikhs, as one of the five articles of their faith. The right to carry the weapon is constitutionally guaranteed for Sikhs in India, which allows them to even board flights with the blade. To follow rules around the world, some forms of the dagger cannot be removed from the sheath. 

